JTAGprobe_smp

A CMSIS-DAP v2 JTAG and SWD debug probe firmware with an integrated USB CDC-ACM UART serial bridge for the **Raspberry Pi Pico (RP2040)**, running on the **µOS++ III SMP** kernel across both Cortex-M0+ cores.

It is JTAGprobe (branch `jtagprobe-new`, with all of its speed optimizations) with FreeRTOS replaced by µOS++ III SMP (`micro-os-plus-iii-smp`). The Pico SDK still boots the board; the kernel then schedules the probe's threads on both cores: **core 0** serves the USB host (tinyusb) and the UART bridge, **core 1** runs nothing but the CMSIS-DAP commands (the JTAG/SWD bit-banging).

Features

- **JTAG & SWD Debugging:** Full CMSIS-DAP v2 bulk transport support for OpenOCD, pyOCD, probe-rs, and Keil MDK.
- **Hardware USB CDC-ACM UART Bridge:** Virtual COM port (`/dev/ttyACMx` on Linux, `COMx` on Windows) bridged directly to target UART on GPIO 12/13.
- **High Performance:**
  - Zero blocking debug logging overhead on DAP transfers.
  - Single-cycle RP2040 SIO atomic register operations for high-speed bit-banging.
  - Multi-packet ring buffer (4 slots) preventing USB NAK back-offs.
- **Dual-core (SMP):** the DAP thread has core 1 to itself, so JTAG/SWD bit-banging overlaps the USB transfers and the UART bridge on core 0.
- **Dynamic Baud Rate:** Automatically adjusts hardware UART baud rate, parity, stop bits, and data bits when changed by the host terminal software.
- **Supported Hardware:**
  - Raspberry Pi Pico (RP2040). The µOS++ port in this tree (`micro-os-plus-iii-rp2040`) is RP2040-only; there is no Pico 2 (RP2350) build of JTAGprobe_smp.

µOS++ III SMP Integration

Source layout

Path	What it is
`micro-os-plus/micro-os-plus-iii/`	The µOS++ III SMP kernel, unmodified (a `git archive` of `micro-os-plus-iii`, branch `smp`, commit `931f1380`). CMake INTERFACE library `micro-os-plus::iii`.
`micro-os-plus/micro-os-plus-iii-rp2040/`	The RP2040 port, an INTERFACE library `micro-os-plus::rp2040` on top of the kernel, built the way the `micro-os-plus-iii-smp` tests link `micro-os-plus::cortexm`.
`src/cmsis-plus/os-app-config.h`	The kernel configuration: 1000 Hz tick, stack sizes.
`src/probe_os.h`	The objects the threads share: `usb_mutex`, `usb_sem`, `dap_sem`, `uart_sem`.
`CMakeLists.txt`	Pico SDK project; `add_subdirectory(micro-os-plus/micro-os-plus-iii-rp2040)` and links `micro-os-plus::rp2040`.

The RP2040 port

Item	Implementation
CPUs	`OS_NCPU=2`, `OS_USE_SMP_SCHEDULER=1`
Context switch	ARMv6-M PendSV, lowest priority, one per core
Tick	SysTick on both cores, 1 kHz; only core 0 advances the system clock
Kernel lock	SIO hardware spinlock `PICO_SPINLOCK_ID_OS1` (14), the one the Pico SDK reserves for an RTOS
Critical sections	PRIMASK
Cross-core IPI	SIO inter-core FIFO, `SIO_IRQ_PROC0` / `SIO_IRQ_PROC1`
High-resolution clock	`time_us_64()` (1 MHz timer)
Core 1 start	`os_rp2040_start_core1()` → `multicore_launch_core1_raw()` on the SDK's core-1 stack, then an `idle1` thread
Free store	`__end__` … `__HeapLimit` (the SDK linker script's heap)
Process exit	The Pico SDK's `exit()`; the port removes the kernel's `src/libc/stdlib/exit.c` from the build

Threads

Thread	Priority	Core	Job
`UART`	high	0	CDC ↔ `uart0` bridge (must preempt USB, or characters are lost)
`TUD`	above normal	0	`tud_task()`, then services the DAP endpoints
`DAP`	normal	1	`DAP_ExecuteCommand()`: the JTAG/SWD bit-banging
`main`	—	0	`os_main()`: probe init, creates the threads, starts core 1

tinyusb is built with `OPT_OS_NONE`; every tinyusb call is made with `usb_mutex` held. The DAP requests and responses cross between the cores in two lock-free single-producer/single-consumer rings (`src/tusb_edpt_handler.c`). The DAP thread busy-waits up to 2 ms for the next packet before it sleeps, and starts the IN transfer of each response itself when it gets `usb_mutex` (otherwise the `TUD` thread does it right after `tud_task()`). The `TUD` thread likewise keeps polling `tud_task()` for 2 ms after the last DAP packet instead of sleeping.

DAP packets are **512 bytes** (`DAP_PACKET_SIZE`, CMSIS-DAP v2) over the 64-byte full-speed bulk endpoint, so OpenOCD packs eight times more into each round trip. A request arrives as up to eight USB packets; since the host sends no ZLP, `dap_req_len()` parses the DAP command lengths to find where a request ends on a full 64-byte packet, and a response of a 64-byte multiple shorter than 512 bytes is followed by a ZLP.

Packet timing

The firmware keeps per-stage packet timing (OUT → DAP start, DAP execution, response → IN, IN transfer, OUT → OUT, OUT stalls), read from OpenOCD with the DAP vendor command `0x80`:

```
cmsis-dap cmd 0x80 0xff     ;# reset the counters
cmsis-dap cmd 0x80 <i>      ;# read counter i (0..11), printed as "Returned data b0 b1 b2 b3"
```

The counters and a measured breakdown are in `PERFORMANCE_ANALYSIS_AND_OPTIMIZATION.md` § 8.5 and § 9.4.

OpenOCD Load Times (Raspberry Pi 4 B over JTAG)

`load_image` of µOS++ test ELFs into a Raspberry Pi 4 B (BCM2711) over JTAG, OpenOCD `adapter speed 4000`, CMSIS-DAP v2 bulk, timed around `load_image` alone. See `PERFORMANCE_ANALYSIS_AND_OPTIMIZATION.md` § 9 for every measurement and the per-test table.

Probe firmware	Measured rate	~80 KB image
Stock debugprobe 2.0.0	~1.05 KB/s	~77 s
JTAGprobe `jtagprobe-new` (FreeRTOS, single core)	34.0–39.5 KB/s	2.0–2.4 s
JTAGprobe_smp, first build (DAP thread slept per packet; fixed in the second)	9.95 KB/s	8.1 s
JTAGprobe_smp, second build (DAP thread spins, sends its own responses)	37.8–38.1 KB/s	2.1 s
JTAGprobe_smp, third build (+ `TUD` spin, packet timing)	37.6–38.5 KB/s	2.1 s
JTAGprobe_smp, current build (+ 512-byte DAP packets)	**48.4–49.3 KB/s**	**1.65 s**

With 64-byte packets the SMP build loads at the speed of the optimized single-core firmware (about 3.8× faster than the first SMP build). Its packet counters showed the core-to-core hand-off costs ~7 µs of a ~263 µs cycle; the rest was the JTAG bit-banging (~68 µs) and the USB round trip with the PC (~188 µs). So the current build moves 512-byte packets: 8.6× fewer round trips, loads **23 % faster** (about 47× the stock firmware), and all tests pass faster:

hwd test, Pi 4 B	64-byte packets	512-byte packets
smp_mem_test	50.2 s	**47.1 s**
smp_mem_inter_test	186–193 s	**175.9 s**
smp_mem_test, `SEMI_PRINTS=1`	337.4 s	**308.1 s**
smp_mem_inter_test, `SEMI_PRINTS=1`	620.5 s	**561.8 s**

The load gains less than the 8× fewer packets: the bit-banging per byte is unchanged, and receiving a request in 64-byte USB packets plus the PC's turnaround now takes ≈ 910 µs of a ≈ 1,740 µs cycle (not yet split, see `PERFORMANCE_ANALYSIS_AND_OPTIMIZATION.md` § 9.6). With semihosting prints on (`SEMI_PRINTS=1`) each semihosted line still costs ~0.9 s, OpenOCD reading each string byte by byte.

Pinout Mapping

Connect the probe to your target board as follows:

Signal	RP2040 GPIO	Pico Header Pin	Direction / Role	Description
SWCLK / TCK	**GPIO 19**	**Pin 25**	Output (Probe →\rightarrow Target)	SWD Clock / JTAG Test Clock
SWDIO / TMS	**GPIO 14**	**Pin 19**	Bi-directional	SWD Data I/O / JTAG Test Mode Select
TDI	**GPIO 18**	**Pin 24**	Output (Probe →\rightarrow Target)	JTAG Test Data In
TDO	**GPIO 21**	**Pin 27**	Input (Probe ←\leftarrow Target)	JTAG Test Data Out
nTRST	**GPIO 15**	**Pin 20**	Output (Probe →\rightarrow Target)	JTAG Test Reset (optional)
nRESET	**GPIO 16**	**Pin 21**	Open-drain (Target Reset)	System Reset
UART_TXD	**GPIO 12**	**Pin 16**	Output (Probe →\rightarrow Target)	Target UART RX (from Pico `uart0`)
UART_RXD	**GPIO 13**	**Pin 17**	Input (Probe ←\leftarrow Target)	Target UART TX (to Pico `uart0`)
GND	**GND**	**Pin 3, 8, 13, 18, 23, 28, 38**	Ground	Common Ground Reference

USB Interfaces & Serial Port

When plugged into a host PC, JTAGprobe_smp enumerates as a composite USB device:

1. **Interface 0 (Vendor Specific Bulk):**
   - CMSIS-DAP v2 interface used by OpenOCD, pyOCD, and debuggers via `libusb`.
   - *Note:* CMSIS-DAP is **not** a serial/tty device and will not appear under `/dev/tty*`.
2. **Interfaces 1 & 2 (CDC-ACM UART Bridge):**
   - Creates a **`/dev/ttyACMx`** on Linux (`/dev/ttyACM0` if it is the only one; or `COMx` on Windows).
   - In system logs (`dmesg`, `/dev/serial/by-id/`), the port inherits the USB product string `JTAG probe on Pico (CMSIS-DAP)`. **It is the serial console port connected to GPIO 12 & 13.**

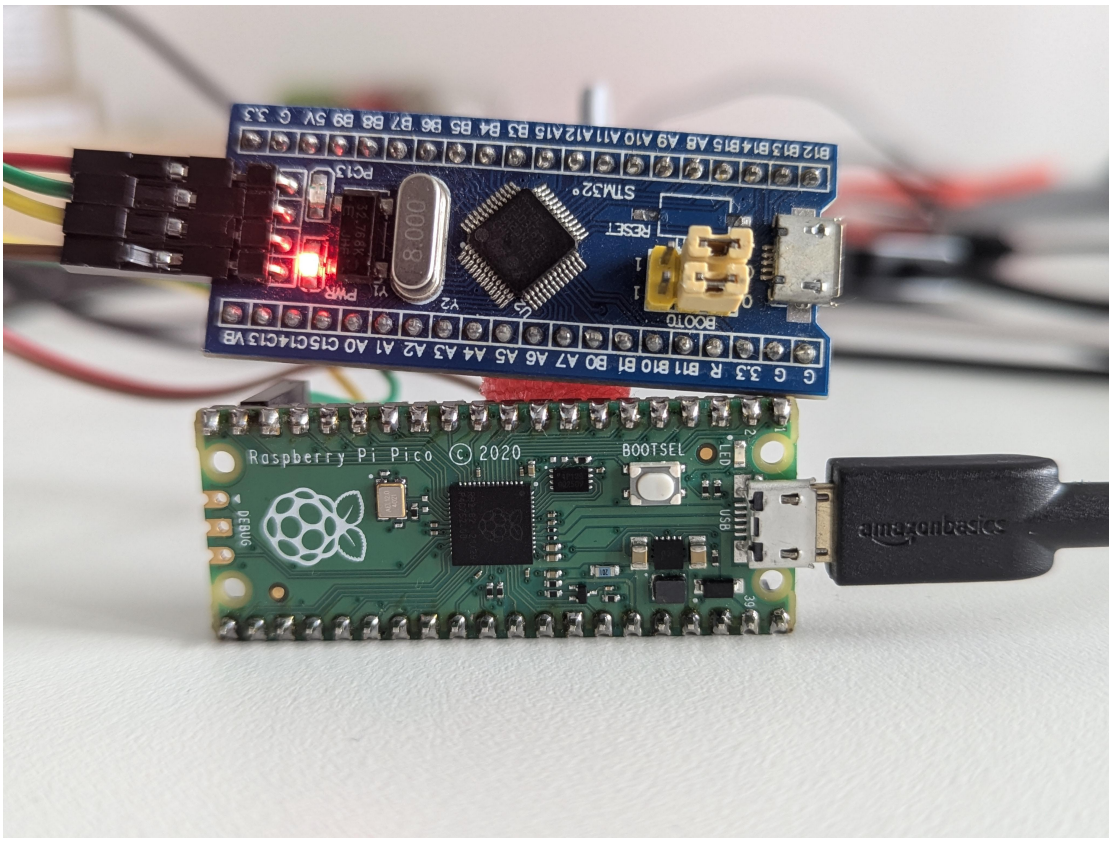
Opening the UART Console

Use any serial terminal application (e.g. `picocom`, `minicom`, `screen`, PuTTY):

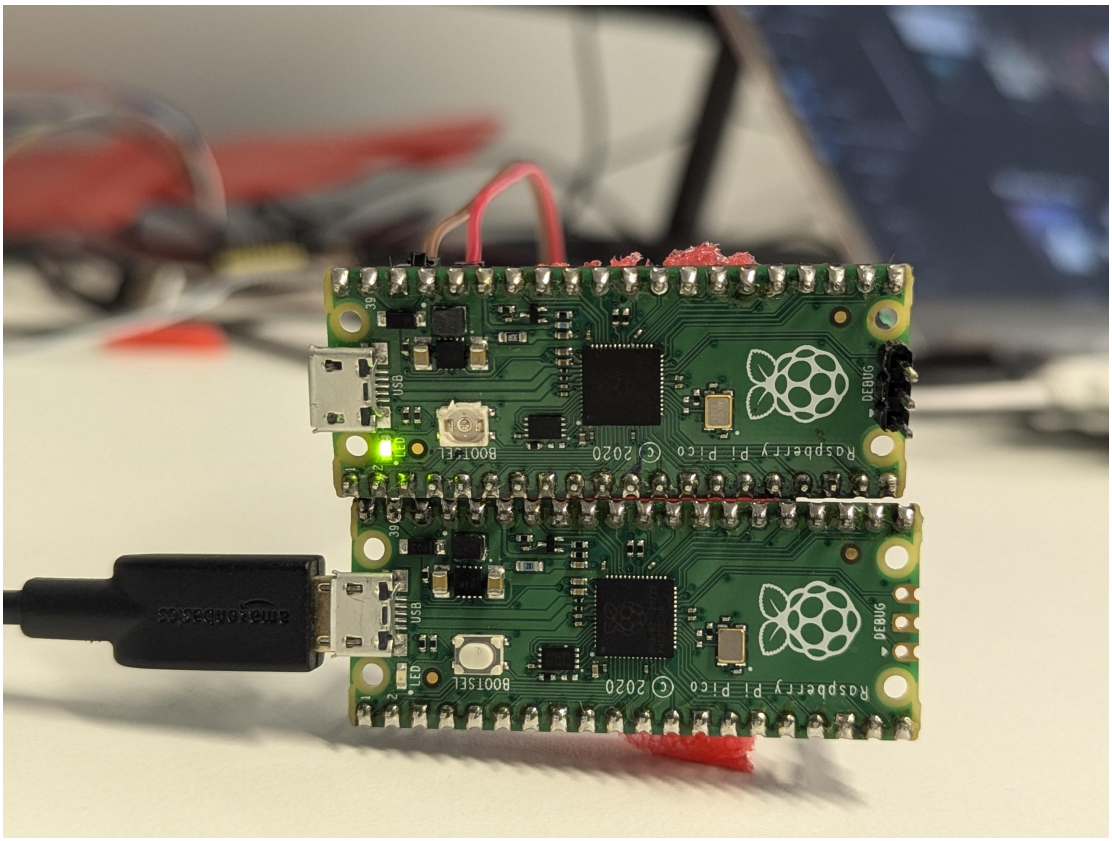
```
# Using picocom at 115200 baud
picocom -b 115200 /dev/ttyACM0
```

```
# Using minicom
minicom -b 115200 -o -D /dev/ttyACM0
```

Images of debugging PICO with another PICO and Bluepill



Bluepill Debug



Pico Debug

Building from Source

1. Prerequisites

- **Raspberry Pi Pico SDK** — Set the `PICO_SDK_PATH` environment variable:

  ```
  export PICO_SDK_PATH=/path/to/pico-sdk
  ```

- **CMake** (3.20 or higher; the µOS++ CMake files need it)
- **GCC ARM Embedded Toolchain** (`arm-none-eabi-gcc`)
- **Ninja** (or `make`)
- **picotool** (found by the SDK, e.g. `-Dpicotool_DIR=$HOME/.local/lib/cmake/picotool`)

The µOS++ kernel and its RP2040 port are already in `micro-os-plus/`; nothing else needs fetching.

2. Building the Firmware (Raspberry Pi Pico, RP2040)

From the folder that holds `JTAGprobe_smp/`:

```
cmake -S JTAGprobe_smp -B JTAGprobe_smp/build/pico -G Ninja -DPICO_BOARD=pico
ninja -C JTAGprobe_smp/build/pico
```

The output binary is: **`build/pico/JTAGprobe_smp.uf2`**

The firmware is linked `copy_to_ram`: it runs from SRAM, not from XIP flash.

Flashing the Firmware

1. **Hold the BOOTSEL button** on your Pico board.
2. **Plug the board into your computer's USB port** while holding BOOTSEL (the device mounts as a mass-storage drive named `RPI-RP2`).
3. **Copy `build/pico/JTAGprobe_smp.uf2`** to the drive.
4. The Pico will automatically reboot and start running JTAGprobe_smp with CMSIS-DAP v2 and USB CDC UART on GPIO 12/13.

Final Reflection: One CPU vs Two CPUs

Measured on a Raspberry Pi 4 B target over JTAG with OpenOCD 0.12 (`adapter speed 4000`), comparing the optimized single-core FreeRTOS JTAGprobe (`jtagprobe-new`) with JTAGprobe_smp (µOS++ III SMP, DAP on core 1, USB and UART on core 0). Details in `PERFORMANCE_ANALYSIS_AND_OPTIMIZATION.md` § 9 and § 11.

	1 CPU (FreeRTOS)	**2 CPUs (JTAGprobe_smp)**
`load_image`, smp_mem_inter_test (80,984 B)	2,380 ms (34.0 KB/s)	**2,106–2,143 ms (37.8–38.5 KB/s)**
Whole smp_mem_test (CTest, reset wait included)	140 s	**50–54 s**
Whole smp_mem_inter_test	190 s	186–193 s

Both columns use 64-byte DAP packets. The 512-byte packets of the current build (1,644 ms, 47.1 s and 175.9 s for the same three rows) cut round trips, which would help a single-core firmware in the same way, so they are left out of this one-vs-two comparison.

JTAG operations (bulk, e.g. `load_image`). Two CPUs give about the same speed as one: the load is a strict request/reply exchange (OpenOCD sends one packet, ~9.9 loaded bytes, and waits for its answer). Of a ~263 µs cycle the probe's counters show ~68 µs of bit-banging, ~7 µs of hand-off between the two cores and ~188 µs of USB transfer and PC turnaround. A second core cannot overlap anything in a chain where each step waits for the previous one; it can only cost time if the hand-off sleeps. The first SMP build did exactly that (two cross-core wake-ups per packet, ~1 ms per packet, 4× slower; history, fixed since the second build), and keeping the packet path free of sleeps (the DAP thread spins and sends its own reply) brought it back to single-core speed.

JTAG operations (scattered, e.g. a running test). Here two CPUs pay off: smp_mem_test, whose run is OpenOCD polling the four Cortex-A72 cores between short exchanges, finished in 50–54 s instead of 140 s. The DAP work on core 1 never waits behind USB event handling or the UART on core 0. (The exact share of each factor was not profiled.) Where the test itself dominates (smp_mem_inter_test, ~170 s of computing on the Pi), one or two probe CPUs make no measurable difference: 186–193 s against 190 s, within its run-to-run spread.

UART. On one CPU the UART bridge task and the DAP task share a core, so the bridge has to preempt the bit-banging to avoid losing characters. On two CPUs the UART thread runs on core 0 next to USB and never delays a DAP command, and no DAP burst can delay the UART. The tests ran with the full console on the UART and passed; the bridge throughput itself was not benchmarked.

Semihosting. To the probe a semihosting call is just more JTAG traffic, so it benefits like any scattered JTAG work. But its cost is set by OpenOCD: `SYS_WRITE0` reads the string from the target one byte per JTAG access, about 0.9 s per console line. With every core-0 line sent through semihosting (`SEMI_PRINTS=1`) smp_mem_test takes 337 s and smp_mem_inter_test 621 s, against 50–54 s and 186–193 s without. Neither one nor two probe CPUs change that; reading the string in blocks on the host would. On this board OpenOCD also serves semihosting only from core 0 of the target: a call from cores 1–3 leaves that core halted.

Where the next gains are. Not in another split of work between the two Pico cores (the hand-off is already ~7 µs per packet), but in fewer round trips (a larger `DAP_PACKET_SIZE`: **done**, 512 bytes, loads 23 % faster and tests 6–10 % faster; the request reception left in each cycle is the next thing to measure), faster bit-banging (PIO), and on the host side (block reads for semihosting strings).